Academic paper elements check

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AP RESEARCH · BEFORE YOU SUBMIT A DRAFT · YOUR OWN CHECK OF YOUR OWN PAPER

STUDENT CODE _____ PERIOD _____ DATE _____

College Board's rule. "The body of the academic paper must contain the elements listed in the following table." The words in the middle column are College Board's own, from the Course and Exam Description.

Element	What College Board says it does	My pages
Introduction and Literature Review	Introduces research question/project goal and reviews previous work in the field. Synthesizes the varying perspectives in the scholarly literature to situate the research question/project goal within a gap in the current field of knowledge.	
Method, Process, or Approach	Explains and provides justification for the chosen method, process, or approach and its alignment with the research question.	
Results, Product, or Findings	Presents the findings, evidence, results, or performance/exhibit/product generated by the research method.	
Discussion, Analysis, and/or Evaluation	Interprets the significance of the results, performance/exhibit/product, or findings; explores connections to original research question/project goal.	
Conclusion and Future Directions	Articulates the new understanding generated through the research process and the limitations of the conclusion or creative work. Discusses the implications to the community of practice. Identifies areas for future research.	
Bibliography	Provides a complete list of sources cited and consulted in the appropriate disciplinary style.	

Length

☐	**4,000 to 5,000 words.** My count is _____.
☐	**Counted correctly.** Titles, sub-headings, and in-text citations count. Graphs, figures, data tables, images, appendices, the abstract, footnoted citations, and the bibliography do not.

Form

☐	**A paper.** It is in the format of a paper in my discipline. Anything else submitted as final, such as a slide deck, scores 0.
☐	**Sources acknowledged.** Every source is cited in the text and listed in the bibliography.

This sheet checks that each element is present. It does not judge quality, and nobody fills it in for you.